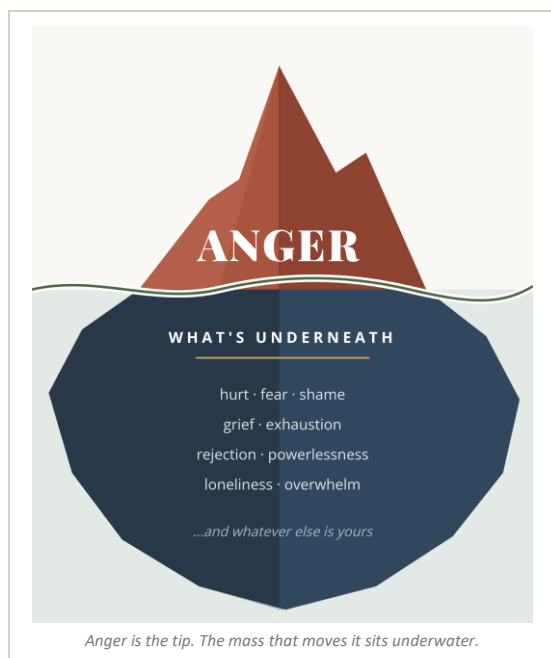




The Anger Iceberg

Anger is usually a **secondary emotion** — the emotion that is visible. Underneath sit the feelings that are harder to say out loud, and those are the ones that need something from you. This page is for naming them. There are no right answers, and you don't have to fill in every box.



Above the surface

When I'm angry, this is what other people actually see. Check the ones that apply to you.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Raised voice / sharp tone | ☐ Going quiet, shutting down |
| ☐ Sarcasm or a cutting joke | ☐ Criticizing or blaming |
| ☐ Slamming, throwing, pacing | ☐ Walking out of the room |
| ☐ Replaying the argument | ☐ Going cold / withdrawing |

Start with one moment

Recall one specific time you got angry this week. Choose something specific. Everything on this page will refer back to that one incident.

What Was Under the Water? Circle every word that fits. Most people find more than one.

Hurt	Afraid	Ashamed	Disrespected	Rejected	Embarrassed
Grief	Lonely	Overwhelmed	Exhausted	Anxious	Guilty
Powerless	Unheard	Betrayed	Disappointed	Jealous	Trapped
Unappreciated	Insecure	Frustrated	Worried	Sad	Hungry / tired
Threatened	Abandoned	Judged	other: _____	other: _____	other: _____

The one that I feel today:

What was it trying to tell me:

Early Warning Signs Anger often shows up first. Learning your signals buys you time to react differently.

IN MY BODY

- ☐ Jaw or fists clench
- ☐ Chest / face heats up
- ☐ Heart speeds up
- ☐ Shoulders rise
- ☐ Stomach tightens

IN MY THOUGHTS

- ☐ "They always..."
- ☐ "This isn't fair."
- ☐ Building the case
- ☐ Rehearsing a comeback
- ☐ All-or-nothing thinking

IN WHAT I DO

- ☐ Talk faster / louder
- ☐ Interrupt
- ☐ Go silent
- ☐ Get busy or distracted
- ☐ Reach for a numbing habit

A note on anger: anger itself isn't the problem, and it isn't a character flaw. It's a signal — usually that something mattered, a line got crossed, or a need went unmet. The work isn't to stop feeling it. It's to hear what it's pointing at before it does the talking for you.



Working With What's Underneath

The first page was for noticing. This page is for doing something with it. Use the information below to map your patterns, journal about them, and have a plan ready before the next wave.

Trigger Map *Fill in a row each time. Patterns show up faster on paper than in memory.*

WHAT HAPPENED	UNDER THE ANGER, I FELT...	WHAT I ACTUALLY NEEDED	WHAT I DID	WHAT I'LL TRY NEXT TIME
He answered a text while I was mid-sentence.	Unimportant. Small.	To be listened to.	Went cold, said "never mind."	"I'd like to finish — can the phone wait?"

Journal Prompts for Anger *Pick one. A new one each time, or the same one revisited.*

CBT — THOUGHT RECORD

Situation: _____. The thought that lit the match: _____.
Evidence for it. Evidence against it. A version of the thought that's still honest but less on fire: _____.

UNSENT LETTER

Write the letter you will never send — no editing, no fairness required. Then write one line at the bottom: what you'd actually want them to understand.

VALUES & DIRECTION

What value of yours was being stepped on? Did the way you responded move you toward or away from the person you want to be?

IFS / PARTS WORK

Speak to the angry part directly. How old does it feel? What is it protecting, and what is it afraid would happen if it stood down? What does it need to hear from you?

NEEDS & BOUNDARIES

What need went unmet in that moment? Was it ever spoken out loud? Write the request you could make instead of the accusation you wanted to make.

SELF-COMPASSION

Write about the moment as a friend who loves you would describe it. What would they say you were carrying that day that you're not giving yourself credit for?

SOMATIC / BODY-BASED

Where does the anger live in your body right now? Give it a shape, a temperature, a speed. If that place could speak in one sentence, what would it say?

INNER CHILD

When did this feeling first show up in your life? What did anger do for you back then, and is that still the job it needs to do now?

AFTERMATH & REPAIR

Who was affected, including you? What's one specific thing repair could look like — and what would you need to feel steady enough to offer it?

In the Moment *Practice these when you're calm, so they're available when you're not.*

Slow the exhale Breathe in for 4, out for 8, six or seven times. The long exhale is what tells your nervous system the threat has passed.	Name it to tame it Say the feeling under the anger, silently or out loud: "I'm hurt." Naming it lowers its volume.	Move it through Walk, stretch, take the stairs. Anger is mobilizing energy — give it somewhere to go that isn't a person.	Pause, don't quit "I want to keep talking about this, and I need twenty minutes first." A break with a return time isn't stonewalling.
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TODAY'S ENTRY

Prompt used:

Date:
